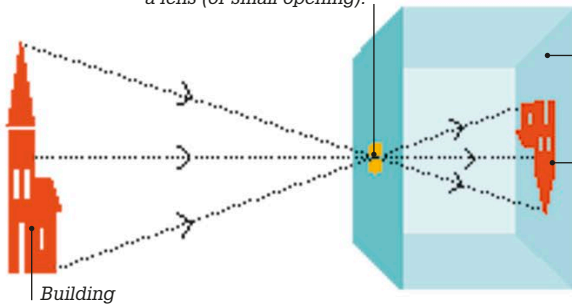


1570 ▶ 1590

Telling the time
See pages 80–81

19th-century replica of the Strasbourg astronomical clock

The light passes through a lens (or small opening).



Darkened room

The image of the building appears upside down on the opposite wall.

Moving figures



1570

Camera obscura

Italian scholar Giambattista della Porta refined the camera obscura—an optical device that projects an image of an object through a pinhole (small opening) onto a flat surface. Instead of using a pinhole to focus the image, della Porta used a convex lens (see p.137). This innovation imitated the shape of the lens in the human eye.

1574

Complex timepiece

An astronomical clock, nearly 59 ft (18 m) high, was built in the Cathedral of Notre-Dame in Strasbourg (now in France). It included a celestial globe, an astrolabe, a calendar dial, and automata (moving figures), representing the latest ideas in mathematics, astronomy, and clockmaking.

1570

1575

1577

Taqi al-Din's observatory

Islamic scientist Taqi al-Din built an observatory in Istanbul (in modern-day Turkey) equipped with the latest instruments for measuring the positions of the planets and other heavenly bodies. Unfortunately, he also incorrectly predicted that the Sultan would win a war against the Persians. When he lost, the Sultan ordered the observatory to be pulled down.

Typhoid fever

In 1576, Italian physician Gerolamo Cardano wrote the first clinical description of the symptoms of typhoid fever. This highly infectious disease killed many people.

Astronomers at work in Taqi al-Din's observatory in Istanbul

